



Security Focus: CIA Triad



It's time to introduce you to a key concept in computer security: the CIA triad. You might be thinking "Cool...I love a good spy story!"



Hold on there! This is not a story about spies - although the CIA triad IS important to the Central Intelligence Agency and every other three-letter agency in this country.



The CIA triad is, among other things, the way that security professionals categorize various security threats and attacks.



Threats and attacks? Now THAT'S interesting, yes?



People who are or will be computer professionals, researchers, and educators are on the front line cyber-defense.



Wait...that's us! How exciting!



Yes...we are key to protecting our nation's critical information assets and infrastructure! But before you can do that, you will need to understand the CIA triad.



The "C" in CIA stands for confidentiality and means that information must be kept private and secure.



The "I" in CIA stands for integrity and means that data should not be modified, deleted or added to by unauthorized persons or systems.



Finally, the "A" in CIA stands for availability, which means that systems must be available to whomever requires them.



As we delve into specific security topics, we will discuss how they impact each of these three key elements.



For now, just remember that the CIA triad is a key concept in information security and that "C" stands for confidentiality, "I" stands for integrity and "A" stands for availability.